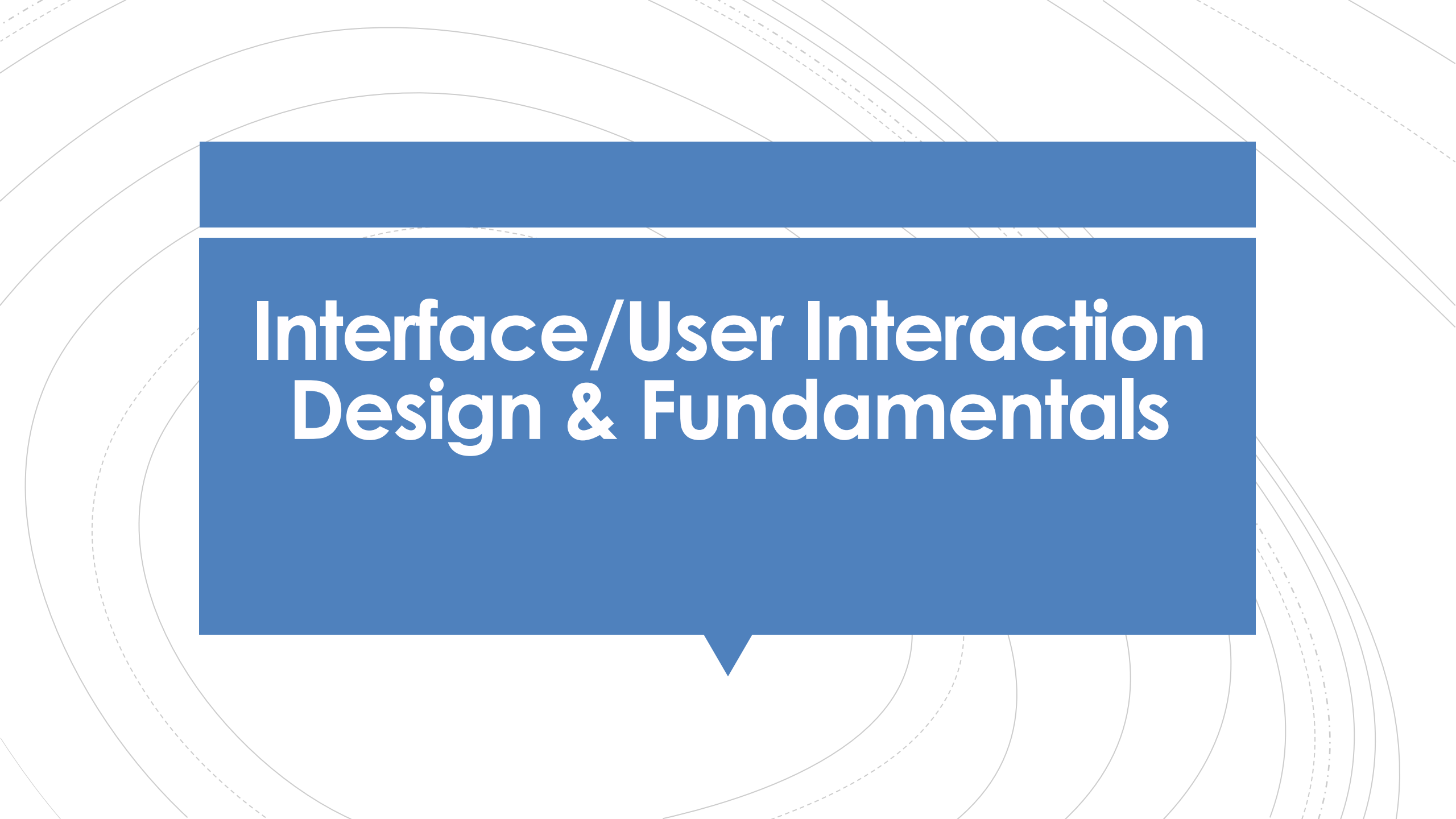


The background features a series of concentric circles in light gray, some solid and some dashed, creating a ripple effect. A large, solid blue speech bubble is centered on the page, pointing downwards. The text is white and bold, centered within the bubble.

Interface/User Interaction Design & Fundamentals

What is a persona

- What is a persona?
- Where and what is it used for?

Personas

- A persona is a way to model, summarize and communicate research about people who have been observed or researched in some way.
- A persona is depicted as a specific person but is not a real individual; rather, it is synthesized from observations of many people.

Personas

- Each persona represents a significant portion of people in the real world and enables the designer to focus on a manageable and memorable cast of characters, instead of focusing on thousands of individuals.
- Personas aid designers to create different designs for different kinds of people and to design for a specific somebody, rather than a generic everybody.

What are Personas used For?

- Personas can and should be used throughout the creative process, and they can be used by all members of the software/ web development and design team and even by the entire company. Here are some of the uses they can be put to:

What are Personas used For?

BUILD EMPATHY

- When a designer creates a persona, they are crafting the lens through which they will see the world.
- With those glasses on, it is possible to gain a perspective similar to the user's.
- From this vantage point, when a designer makes a decision, they do so having internalized the persona's goals, needs and wants.

What are Personas used For?

DEVELOP FOCUS

- Personas help us to define who the software or website is being created for and who not to focus on.
- Having a clear target is important. For projects with more than one user type, a list of personas will help you to prioritize which users are more important than others.
- Simply defining who your users are makes it more apparent that you can't design for everyone, or at least not for everyone at once — or else you risk designing for no one.

What are Personas used For?

COMMUNICATE AND FORM CONSENSUS

- More often than not, designers work on multidisciplinary teams with people with vastly different expertise, knowledge, experience and perspectives.
- As a deliverable, the personas document helps to communicate research findings to people who were not able to be a part of the interviews with users.
- Establishing a medium for shared knowledge brings all members of a team on the same page.

What are Personas used For?

MAKE AND DEFEND DECISIONS

- Just as personas help to prioritize who to design for, they also help to determine what to design for them.
- When you see the world from your user's perspective, then determining what is useful becomes a lot easier.
- When a design choice is brought into question, defending it based on real data and research on users (as represented by a persona) is the best way to show others the logical and user-focused reasoning behind the decision.

What are **Personas** used For?

MEASURE EFFECTIVENESS

- Various implementations of a design can be “tested” by pairing a persona with a scenario, similar to how we test designs with real users.
- If someone who is play-acting a persona cannot figure out how to use a feature or gets frustrated, then the users they represent will probably have a difficult time as well.

What Does a Persona Look Like?

- While a persona is usually presented as a one-pager document, it is more than just a deliverable —
- it is a way to communicate and summarize research trends and patterns to others.
- This fundamental understanding of users is what's important, not the document itself.

What Does A Persona Look Like?

We will have a look at the personas for Car Care, a mobile/tablet app:

- The app allows users to easily and seamlessly manage their vehicles.
- [Car Care Proto Personas](#)

Persona 1

ANNA

THE COLLEGE STUDENT

SINGLE FEMALE, 21 YEARS OLD
San Francisco, CA



PERSONALITY: FUN, DRIVEN, QUIET

"I'm intimidated when I go to a mechanic. I don't understand cars and I can't answer any questions about mine. It makes me feel uncomfortable."

Anna is in her fourth year of college. She lives several hours away from home and enjoys the added responsibility that college has brought. Beyond cooking for herself and washing clothes, she's also improving basic skills, like money management and time management. College and her studies keep Anna very busy.

Anna's room and board are paid for, and she doesn't have a lot of additional expenses. This is good since her only income comes from a 20-hour part-time job on campus where she earns minimum wage.

Anna drives an old Toyota Camry her parents gave her when she was in high school. She doesn't use it often since it always seems to need work. When she was at home, her father would help her with the car. Now that she's away, it's not convenient to ask him about it. Anna feels a little at a loss; she doesn't know anything about cars. She is also suspicious of mechanics taking advantage of her and taking all of her money. It would just be too easy to do.

TECHNOLOGY



TECH SAAVY Gage



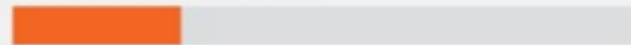
TIME SPENT on Technology



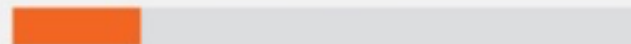
VEHICLE



MILES DRIVEN in a Year



FUEL EFFICIENCY of Vehicle



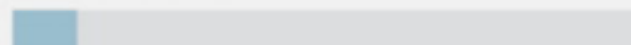
MAINTENANCE RECORDS for Vehicle



SALARY



INCOME LEVEL



FAVORITE APPS



The background of the slide features several thin, curved lines in a light gray color, some solid and some dashed, creating a sense of motion and depth. On the left side, there is a blue speech bubble graphic with a tail pointing towards the bottom left. The text 'Benefits of Persona' is written in white, bold, sans-serif font inside the main body of the speech bubble.

Benefits of Persona

- Personas help to focus decisions surrounding site components by adding a layer of real-world consideration to the conversation.
- They also offer a quick and inexpensive way to test and prioritize those features throughout the development process.

Benefits of Persona

In addition they can help:

- Stakeholders and leaders evaluate new site feature ideas
- Information architects develop informed wireframes, interface behaviors, and labeling
- Designers create the overall look and feel of the website
- System engineers/developers decide which approaches to take based on user behaviors
- Copy writers ensure site content is written to the appropriate audiences

Best Practices for Developing Personas

- Personas development belongs at the beginning of the project, as personas can inform site functionality, help uncover gaps, or highlight new opportunities.
- You may develop one or more personas for a project but limit yourself to the main audiences for the site.
- For any given project, creating only three or four personas is best.
- Remember that it is better to paint with a broad brush and meet the needs of the larger populations than try to meet the needs of everyone.
- The goal of personas is not to represent all audiences or address all needs of the website but instead to focus on the major needs of the most important user groups.

Best Practices for Developing Personas

- To ensure your personas are accurate representations of your users and have the support of your stakeholders throughout the process, you should:
- Conduct [user research](#): Answer the following questions: Who are your users and why are they using the system? What behaviors, assumptions, and expectations color their view of the system?
- Condense the research: Look for themes/characteristics that are specific, relevant, and universal to the system and its users.

Best Practices for Developing Personas

- Brainstorm: Organize elements into persona groups that represent your target users. Name or classify each group.
- Refine: Combine and prioritize the rough personas. Separate them into primary, secondary, and, if necessary, complementary categories. You should have roughly 3-5 personas and their identified characteristics.
- Make them realistic: Develop the appropriate descriptions of each personas background, motivations, and expectations. Do not include a lot of personal information. Be relevant and serious; humor is not appropriate.

Questions to Ask During Persona Development

PURPOSE

- What is the purpose of the site?
- What are the goals of the site?
- Personal
 - What is the age of your person?
 - What is the gender of your person?
 - What is the highest level of education this person has received?

Questions to Ask During Persona Development

PROFESSIONAL

- How much work experience does your person have?
- What is your person's professional background?
- Why will they come to the site? (User needs, interests, and goals)
- Where (or from whom) else is this person getting information about your issue or similar programs or services?
- When and where will users access the site? (User environment and context)

Questions to Ask During Persona Development

TECHNICAL

- What technological devices does your person use on a regular basis?
- What software and/or applications does your person use on a regular basis?
- Through what technological device does your user primarily access the web for information?
- How much time does your person spend browsing the web every day?

Questions to Ask During Persona Development

USER MOTIVATION

- What is your person motivated by?
- What are they looking for?
- What is your person looking to do?
- What are his needs?

Elements of a Persona

- Personas generally include the following key pieces of information:
- Persona Group (i.e. web manager)
- Fictional name
- Job titles and major responsibilities
- Demographics such as age, education, ethnicity, and family status
- The goals and tasks they are trying to complete using the site
- Their physical, social, and technological environment
- A quote that sums up what matters most to the persona as it relates to your site
- Casual pictures representing that user group

Personas

GROUP EXERCISE

- Given what you know about personas, in your Project 1 groups put together a persona for the target audience research you did for your assignments.
- Create a persona for your primary and secondary target audience research.